

September 24, 2026

Via Electronic Mail

Mark N. Templeton, Esq.
6020 S. University Avenue
Chicago, IL 60637

RE: MPSC Case No. U-22070 – In the matter of the application of Consumers Energy Company for authority to increase its rates for the generation and distribution of electricity and for other relief.

Dear Mr. Templeton:

Attached to this letter are copies of the following documents:

- Consumers Energy Company's response to discovery 22070-UCC-CE-0892, and 0897-0902; and
- The public Excel attachment pertaining to these responses are being provided electronically to all parties.

A Proof of service has been electronically filed in this docket. Please contact me if you have any questions regarding this matter.

Sincerely,



Digitally signed by Gary A.
Gensch, Jr.
Date: 2026.09.24 14:34:15
-04'00'

Gary A. Gensch Jr.
Phone: 517-788-0698
Email: gary.genschjr@cmsenergy.com

CC Parties Per Attachment 1 to the Proof of Service

Question:

3. By census tract, please provide the following data by month, starting in January 2019, through the most recent month available. If data is not available by month, provide data at the most available frequency (e.g., quarterly, annually, etc.). Please provide the census tract identifier in the 11-digit US Census FIPS Code form. This should include the 2-digit state FIPS code + 3-digit county FIPS code + 6-digit county FIPS code (e.g., Census Tract 2231 in Harris County, TX is 48201223100). Provide all responses in unlocked, native Excel (.xlsx) or .csv format with formulas intact.

- a. The total number of residential customers with arrears overall;
- b. The total number of low-income residential customers with arrears overall;
- c. The total number of low-income residential customers in arrears > 60 days;
- d. The total amount of arrears for all low-income customers;
- e. The total amount of arrears for all residential customers in arrears > 60 days; and
- f. The total amount of arrears for all low-income residential customers in arrears > 60 days.

Response:

See U22070-UCC-CE-0859_Gast_Att_1

Witness: Alex M Gast

Date: September 24, 2026

Question:

8. Please refer to U22070-UCC-CE-0108_Gast_Att_1 UPDATED.xlsx, provided as response to U22070-UCC-CE-0423. In sheets 'j' and 'k,' Does "count_ca" in sheet "j" represent the number of customer accounts to which late fees were applied? Does "count_ca_li" in sheet "k" represent the number of low-income customer account to which the late fees were applied? If yes, please state so. If no, please provide the following data by calendar year, from 2019 through 2025. Provide all responses in unlocked, native Excel (.xlsx) or .csv format with formulas intact. Please provide the census tract identifier in the 11-digit US Census FIPS Code form. This should include the 2-digit state FIPS code + 3-digit county FIPS code + 6-digit county FIPS code (e.g., Census Tract 2231 in Harris County, TX is 48201223100).

- a. Number of total residential customers subjected to late fees; and
- b. Number of total low-income residential customers subject to late fees.

Response:

Yes, these are both distinct counts of customer accounts without and with the income assistance credits.

Witness: Alex M Gast

Date: September 24, 2026

Question:

9. Please refer to U22070-UCC-CE-0108_Gast_Att_1 UPDATED.xlsx, sheets "j" and "k", provided as answers to U22070-UCC-CE-0423. Please also refer to census tracts 26077000900 (2019), 26145010200 (2021), 26145000200 (2023), 26145001100 (2023), and 26145000200 (2026). For each of these census tracts and years, sheet "k" reports more cumulative late fees for low-income customers only than all customers, as reported in sheet "j." Please confirm that the responses provided are correct. If correct, please explain why there are more cumulative late fees for the low-income portion of the Company's customers than for all customers? If the responses are not correct, please provide updated values and confirm that the rest of the reported information in sheets "j" and "k" are correct.

Response:

See U22070-UCC-CE-0865_Gast_Att_1 for updated values for sheets "j" and "k."

The census tracts specified in the question are filtered in the attachment by the *request focus row* in Column C.

Witness: Alex M Gast

Date: September 24, 2026

Question:

10. Please refer to U22070-UCC-CE-0109_Gast_Att_1.xlsx and U22070-UCC-CE-0110_Gast_Att_1 UPDATED.xlsx, which report (a) “[a]dditional deposits paid to restore service (total paid to all customers in each zip code and census tract, by year)” and (b) “[r]econnection fees paid to restore service (total paid to all customers in each zip code and census tract, by year)” by zip code and census tract, respectively. In each year, the total summed value for all additional deposits by zip code is very different from the total summed value for all additional deposits by census tract. The same is true when comparing total summed reconnection fees by zip code versus census tract. Please provide, by year, from 2019 to 2025 inclusive:

a. Total summed value of additional deposits paid to restore service for

(i) all zip codes and

(ii) all census tracts. If (i) and (ii) are different, please explain why. If there were errors in the data sets provided in U22070-UCC-CE-0109_Gast_Att_1.xlsx and U22070-UCC-CE-0110_Gast_Att_1 UPDATED.xlsx, please provide updated data sets without errors.

b. Total summed value of reconnection fees paid to restore service for

(i) all zip codes and

(ii) all census tracts. If (i) and (ii) are different, please explain why. If there were errors in the data sets provided in U22070-UCC-CE-0109_Gast_Att_1.xlsx and U22070-UCC-CE-0110_Gast_Att_1 UPDATED.xlsx, please provide updated data sets without errors.

Response:

See U22070-UCC-CE-0866_Gast_Att_1

It should be noted that census tracts and 5-digit zip codes are not a 1:1 comparison and will account for the discrepancy in the total summed values. The Company has also anonymized the aggregates by excluding any geography with less than 15 residential customers. This step also impacts the total summed values.

Witness: Alex M Gast

Date: September 24, 2026

Question:

11. By zip code, please provide the following by year starting in 2019, through 2025 inclusive, in unlocked, native Excel (.xlsx) or .csv format with formulas intact.

- a. Number of residential customers that paid reconnection fees;
- b. Number of residential customers that paid additional deposits;
- c. Number of low income residential customers that paid reconnection fees; and
- d. Number of low income residential customers that paid additional deposits.

Response:

See U22070-UCC-CE-0867_Gast_Att_1

Witness: Alex M Gast

Date: September 24, 2026

Question:

12. By census tract, please provide the following by year starting in 2019, through 2025 inclusive, in unlocked, native Excel (.xlsx) or .csv format with formulas intact, and by census tract identifier in the 11-digit US Census FIPS Code form. This should include the 2-digit state FIPS code + 3-digit county FIPS code + 6-digit county FIPS code (e.g., Census Tract 2231 in Harris County, TX is 48201223100).

- a. Number of residential customers that paid reconnection fees;
- b. Number of residential customers that paid additional deposits;
- c. Number of low income residential customers that paid reconnection fees;
- d. Number of low income residential customers that paid additional deposits;
- e. Number of residential customers that were shutoff;
- f. Number of low income residential customers that were shutoff; and
- g. Number of residential customers experiencing shutoffs who in that year experienced:
 - ♣ No shutoffs
 - ♣ 1 shutoff
 - ♣ 2 shutoffs
 - ♣ 3 shutoffs
 - ♣ 4-6 shutoffs
 - ♣ More than 6 shutoffs

Response:

See U22070-UCC-CE-0868_Gast_Att_1

Witness: Alex M Gast

Date: September 24, 2026

Question:

13. Please reference U22070-UCC-CE-0107 and U22070-UCC-CE-0094. When the column "total_res_ca_count" in U22070-UCC-CE-0107, sheet "a-f" is summed up across zip codes by year, the total customer count appears to be approximately 1.9 million, depending on the year. In U22070-UCC-CE-0094, when the column "total_res_customers_5e" in sheet "e" is summed by year, the total number of customers appears to be closer to approximately 1.6 million, depending on the month/year. There also appears to be a discrepancy in the zip codes reported (in U22070-UCC-CE-0107, approximately 534, when counting column "c" of sheet "a-f", depending on the year and in U22070-UCC-CE-0094, approximately 512, when counting column "b" of sheet "e", depending on the month/year). Please explain why the total customer count and zip codes may differ and please provide Consumers' total number of customers by year, from 2019 to 2025, inclusive. If any previous discovery responses include errors, please provide updated and accurate data sets.

Response:

The "total_res_ca_count" should have been excluded from the data. Based on the query, it appears that column resulted in double counting as it selected multiple accounts with overlapping ranges. That double counting is the reason for the inflated total of approximately 1.9 million customers. The "total_res_customers_5e" is a distinct count of contract accounts active in the month by geography making it more precise. The zip code discrepancy is related to these outcomes; however, the data sources are different and the anonymization rules are being applied differently. The Company suppresses any locale with less than 15 customers. The total provided in "total_res_customers_5e" by month and zip code (the approximately 1.6 million referenced in the question) is the most accurate. Consumers Energy has 1,665,851 active electric customers as of 9/23/2026.

Witness: Alex M Gast

Date: September 24, 2026